THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE · CLASS X · SET 03

Max. Marks: 80 · Alternative correct answers / expressions to be given due credit · Writing: Format 1 + Content 2 + Fluency & accuracy 2

SECTION A — READING SKILLS — 20 marks

1. Read the following passage. **10**

1. Every June, millions of Indian farmers look towards the southwest with the same question: will the monsoon arrive on time? The monsoon, a seasonal wind system that brings heavy rain from June to September, provides nearly seventy per cent of India's annual rainfall. Although the country has built dams and canals, a large part of its farmland still depends directly on these rains, which makes the monsoon the real finance minister of the nation.

2. The effect of the monsoon on crops is easy to see. Rice, cotton, pulses and sugarcane are sown at the start of the rains and harvested in the autumn. A timely and well-spread monsoon gives farmers healthy crops, while a delayed or weak one forces them to sow again, or even leave their fields empty. A heavy burst of rain in a short time can be equally harmful, since it washes away seeds and floods standing crops.

3. The influence of the rains does not end in the fields. When harvests are good, farmers have money to spend, and markets for tractors, clothes and household goods become busy. Food prices remain stable and the government spends less on importing grain. When the monsoon fails, rural incomes fall, prices of vegetables and pulses rise, and many families are pushed into debt. For this reason, the monthly rainfall reports are followed as closely by economists as by farmers. Even the price of a plate of dal in a distant city quietly depends on whether the clouds opened over a village in time.

4. Scientists have lately improved the forecasting of rainfall with the help of satellites, weather radars and computer models. Farmers receive advice on mobile phones about the best time to sow and when to expect heavy showers. Even so, climate change has made the monsoon less predictable, with long dry spells followed by sudden downpours, and forecasts alone cannot protect fields from such swings.

5. Farmers and planners are therefore turning to measures that reduce the risk. Drip irrigation saves water, drought-resistant seeds withstand weak rains, and village ponds store extra water for dry weeks. Crop insurance gives some security when the rains fail. These steps will not change the weather, but they can ensure that a poor monsoon does not turn into a disaster for the family that depends on the land. Above all, they remind us that a country which feeds a billion people must learn to live wisely with uncertain rain, sharing water and knowledge as carefully as it shares its harvest.

Created for academic usage / 416 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why is the monsoon described as 'the real finance minister of the nation'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

> Because the rains decide farm income and thereby the economy.

II. According to Paragraph 2, a heavy burst of rain in a short time harms crops EXCEPT by **1**

(A) washing away seeds
(B) flooding standing crops
(C) forcing farmers to sow again
(D) helping seeds to sprout evenly

> **Ans: (D)** Heavy rain does not improve germination.

III. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from the brackets: A delayed monsoon increases the _____ of farmers. (profits / risk) (Paragraph 2) **1**

> risk

IV. Select the option that is TRUE according to Paragraph 3. **1**

(A) Food prices rise when harvests are good.
(B) When harvests are good, markets become busy.
(C) Only farmers follow rainfall reports.
(D) The government imports more grain after good harvests.

> **Ans: (B)** When harvests are good, markets become busy.

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Satellite : Weather forecast :: Drip irrigation : _____
(A) Saving water
(B) Flooding fields

> **Ans: (A)** Saving water.

VI. Why can forecasts alone not protect farmers in the age of climate change? (Paragraph 4) **2**

> The monsoon has become less predictable, with long dry spells and sudden downpours (1); a forecast can warn farmers but cannot stop damage to crops (1).

VII. What are the main ideas of Paragraph 3 and Paragraph 5? **1**
i. Rainfall affects the whole economy, not only farms.
ii. Farmers can reduce the risk of poor rains by adopting new measures.
iii. The government should stop importing grain.
iv. The monsoon is always harmful.
v. Mobile phones are costly.

Option	Main idea of Paragraph 3	Main idea of Paragraph 5
A	iii	iv
B	ii	i
C	i	ii
D	iv	v

> **Ans: (C)** Paragraph 3 — i; Paragraph 5 — ii.

VIII. What can be inferred about the measures listed in Paragraph 5? Why does the author say they 'will not change the weather'? (Paragraph 5) **2**

> They cannot control rainfall (1) but they can reduce the damage that a poor monsoon causes to a farming family (1).

2. Read the following passage. **10**

1. A survey of 400 students in Classes 8 to 10 examined how much time they spend on screens outside school hours. The findings were striking. Nearly 70% of the students (280) reported using screens for more than three hours a day, while the remaining 30% (120) used them for less. Of those who spend more than three hours, 60% (168) said they watch videos, 25% (70) play games, and the rest use screens mainly for study.

2. The effect on daily life was also studied. Among the 280 heavy users, 49% (about 137) said that they often slept late, compared with only 12 of the 120 lighter users (10%). Similarly, 35% of all the students (140) admitted that they had less time for outdoor play than a year earlier. Teachers noted that students who spent less time on screens were generally more attentive in morning classes. Many students also confessed that they felt restless and bored when they were away from their phones for even an hour, a sign that the habit had grown stronger than they realised.

3. Experts do not suggest banning technology, since many students use it for learning. Instead they advise fixed screen-free hours, family meals without phones and at least an hour of outdoor activity every day. With a little discipline, screens can serve as a tool rather than a habit that controls the day. Parents, too, must set an example, because children copy what they see at home far more readily than what they are told.

Created for academic usage / 250 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

I. Why does the author call the survey's findings 'striking'? (Paragraph 1) **1**

> Because a large majority (70%) spend more than three hours a day on screens.

II. Complete the following by selecting the correct option from those in brackets. Of the heavy users, the largest group mainly use screens to _____. (study / watch videos) (Paragraph 1) **1**

> watch videos

III. Select the option that is TRUE according to Paragraph 2. **1**

(A) More lighter users slept late than heavy users.
(B) Lighter users slept late less often than heavy users.
(C) Heavy users were more attentive in class.
(D) Outdoor play has increased.

> **Ans: (B)** Lighter users slept late less often than heavy users.

IV. Which of the following is the best meaning of 'attentive' in Paragraph 2? **1**

(A) Sleepy
(B) Paying close attention
(C) Noisy
(D) Absent

> **Ans: (B)** Paying close attention.

V. Complete the analogy by selecting the correct option. **1**
Fixed screen-free hours : Discipline :: Outdoor activity : _____

(A) Physical fitness
(B) Screen addiction

> **Ans: (A)** Physical fitness.

VI. Complete the following appropriately. About 168 of the heavy users watch videos, which is ____ % of the 280. (Paragraph 1) **1**

> 60

VII. What do the data in Paragraph 2 suggest about the link between screen time and sleep? **1**

> Heavy screen use is linked to sleeping late (49% against 10%).

VIII. What do experts advise instead of banning technology? Give any two suggestions. (Paragraph 3) **1**

> Fixed screen-free hours, phone-free family meals, an hour of outdoor activity (any two).

IX. How can screens become 'a tool rather than a habit'? Explain in your own words. (Paragraph 3) **2**

> By using them purposefully for learning and limiting time (1); with discipline such as screen-free hours and outdoor play, the user controls the device rather than being controlled (1).

SECTION B — GRAMMAR AND WRITING SKILLS — 20 marks

GRAMMAR — 10

3. Complete any ten of the twelve of the following tasks, as directed. **(10 × 1 = 10)**

I. Fill in the blank using the correct form of the word in brackets for a school notice: **1**
Students are requested to maintain _____ (disciplined) during the assembly.

> discipline

II. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**
She is senior than me by two years.

ERROR	CORRECTION

Error: than — Correction: to (senior to).

III. Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. **1**
By the time the guests arrived, the cook _____ (prepare) the entire meal.

had prepared

IV. Read the given statement. **1**
The coach said to the team, “We will practise at six tomorrow.”
Report it by completing: The coach told the team that _____.

they would practise at six the next day.

V. Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option. **1**
The manager was angry _____ the clerk for the delay.
(A) of
(B) with
(C) to
(D) on

Ans: (B) angry with a person.

VI. Report the following. **1**
“Please help me carry these bags,” the old woman said to the boy.
The old woman requested _____.

the boy to help her carry those bags.

VII. Complete the sentence by choosing the correct option. **1**
He is looking forward _____ his friends at the reunion.
(A) to meet
(B) to meeting
(C) meeting
(D) to have met

Ans: (B) ‘look forward to’ + gerund.

VIII. The sentence has an error. Select the option that correctly identifies it. **1**
Neither of the answers are correct.

No.	Error	Correction
A.	Neither	None
B.	are	is
C.	answers	answer
D.	correct	corrects

Ans: (B) ‘Neither’ takes a singular verb: are → is.

IX. Report the following question. **1**
“Where did you buy this jacket?” my friend asked me.

My friend asked me where I had bought that jacket.

X. Choose the correct option from the brackets. **1**
You _____ (should / used to) inform your parents before going out; it is a matter of courtesy.

should

XI. Fill in the blank with the correct option. **1**

She has _____ patience than her sister.

(A) much
(B) more
(C) most
(D) many

> **Ans: (B)** ‘more’ for the comparison of uncountable.

XII. Identify the error and write the correction. **1**

The furniture in the rooms were old.

ERROR	CORRECTION

> Error: were — Correction: was (furniture is uncountable).

4. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. You are Rohan/Rhea, a resident of Green Park Colony. The street lights in your lane have not worked for two weeks, causing safety problems at night. Write a letter to the Executive Engineer of the Electricity Department, in about 120 words, requesting immediate repair.

> **Format (1), Content (2), Fluency (2).** Points: since when, risk of accidents/theft, elders/children, request prompt action, thanks.
> *Sample:* The Executive Engineer, Electricity Department, Jaipur / Subject: Non-functioning street lights in Lane 4, Green Park Colony. Sir, I wish to bring to your notice that all the street lights in our lane have been out of order for two weeks. The darkness has made it unsafe for residents, especially women, children and the elderly, to walk after sunset, and there have already been two incidents of petty theft. Despite repeated complaints to the local office, no repairs have been made. I request you to depute a team immediately to restore the lights and to ensure regular maintenance. Your prompt action will be highly appreciated. Yours faithfully, Rohan Mehta.

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B. You are Kavya/Kabir. Your school has no facility for rainwater harvesting despite frequent water shortage. Write a letter to the Principal, in about 120 words, proposing a rainwater harvesting system and explaining its advantages.

> **Format (1), Content (2), Fluency (2).** Points: water shortage, roof area, tank/recharge pit, cost modest, benefits, student involvement.
> *Sample:* The Principal, Lotus Public School, Jaipur / Subject: Proposal for rainwater harvesting. Respected Sir, Our school faces a shortage of water every summer, and tankers have to be hired at considerable cost. Since the rooftops are large, I propose installing a rainwater harvesting system with a storage tank and a recharge pit. The cost is modest and can be partly met by the Eco Club's funds. The system will reduce expenses, raise the groundwater level and teach students the value of conservation. We are ready to help with the planning and maintenance. I hope you will give the proposal your kind consideration. Yours obediently, Kavya Sharma.

5. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B. **1 × 5 = 5**

A. Two students are being considered for the post of School Sports Captain. **Dev:** an outstanding footballer who wins matches single-handedly, but he rarely listens to teammates and often argues with referees. **Tara:** an average player, but she encourages juniors, plans practice sessions and resolves disputes calmly. Analyse the profiles and decide who should be Sports Captain. (100–120 words)

> **Content (2), Organisation (1), Fluency (2).**
> *Sample:* Tara is the better choice for Sports Captain. A captain must lead the entire team, not merely score goals, and Tara's ability to plan, encourage and settle disputes shows true leadership. Dev's skill is undeniable, yet his refusal to listen to teammates and his arguments with referees set a poor example for juniors and could harm the school's reputation. Tara may not be the strongest player, but her calm temperament will build team spirit and discipline. Dev can still contribute as a star player and mentor if he learns humility. On balance, Tara's qualities of cooperation and responsibility make her the more suitable captain.

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B. The table compares two ways of travelling from Jaipur to Delhi.

Features	Bus	Train
Fare	₹550	₹320
Journey time	5.5 hours	4.5 hours
Departures per day	40	6
Luggage space	Limited	Ample
Comfort	Reclining seats	Berth/chair car

Study the data and write an analytical paragraph in 100–120 words comparing them and recommending the better option for a family with heavy luggage.

Content (2), Analysis/recommendation (1), Fluency (2).
Sample: Travelling by train is cheaper at ₹320 against ₹550 for the bus, and it is faster by an hour. The train also offers ample luggage space and comfortable seating, while the bus has limited room for bags. The bus, however, has far more departures, which gives flexibility in timing, whereas only six trains run each day. For a family with heavy luggage, the train is clearly the better choice because it is economical, quicker and spacious. The bus would be suitable only if the family must leave at an odd hour. Overall, advance booking on a train provides the most convenient journey.

SECTION C — LITERATURE TEXTBOOK — 40 marks

6. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

The writer says that the hills of Coorg are covered with coffee estates and spice plants, and that clouds sit low among the trees. The people there, the Kodavus, are proud of their traditions and warm towards guests. Many families have sent their sons to serve in the army, and the region is known for producing brave soldiers.

(Glimpses of India (Coorg) — extract adapted)

I. What is Coorg famous for? **1**

(A) Textile mills
(B) Coffee estates and spices
(C) Deserts
(D) Ports

Ans: (B) Coffee estates, spices and brave soldiers.

II. What is said about the Kodavus' attitude towards guests? **1**

They are warm and hospitable.

III. Complete suitably. Many Kodavu families send their sons to the _____. **1**

(A) police
(B) army
(C) railways
(D) courts

Ans: (B) army.

IV. Which two qualities of the people of Coorg does the extract highlight? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

Pride in tradition and hospitality (1); bravery shown by service in the army (1).

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(b)

The little otter was kept in a small box on the journey. He cried and clung to the writer at first, but soon began to play in the bath and splash about with such joy that the water covered the whole floor. From then on the writer knew that he would have to look after an animal who treated every day as a game.

(Mijbil the Otter — extract adapted)

I. Where was the otter kept during the journey? **1**

(A) In a cage
(B) In a small box
(C) In a car
(D) In a bag

Ans: (B) In a small box.

II. What shows that Mijbil was playful? **1**

He splashed in the bath.

III. Complete suitably. The writer realised that the otter treated every day as a _____. **1**

(A) fight
(B) game
(C) task
(D) burden

Ans: (B) game.

IV. How does the extract show the writer's growing bond with Mijbil? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

Mijbil clings to the writer first (1); the writer accepts the responsibility of caring for him with amusement (1).

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for any one of the given two, (a) or (b). **5**

(a)

The poet says that to recognise wild animals one need not be afraid. A tiger is known by the pattern of its fur and by the way it glides. If one gets close enough to meet it, there will be little time to wonder about its looks, because by then it will be too late.

(How to Tell Wild Animals — paraphrased)

I. How does the poem advise recognising a tiger? **1**

(A) By its colour
(B) By its fur pattern and walk
(C) By its size
(D) By its cry

Ans: (B) By its fur and gliding walk.

II. What is the poet's tone in these lines? **1**

(A) Serious
(B) Humorous
(C) Angry
(D) Grieving

Ans: (B) Humorous / ironic.

III. The warning that 'it will be too late' is meant to be _____. **1**

(A) tragic
(B) funny and ironic
(C) factual
(D) instructive

Ans: (B) funny and ironic.

IV. How does the poet create humour in the poem? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

By giving mock instructions to identify dangerous animals (1); the humour lies in the fact that one would only recognise them when attacked (1).

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(b)

> *A young man replies to an elderly lady that people do not love him for his golden hair alone. He says that his hair may be admired, but only God can love him for himself, and he does not want to be loved only for what he looks like.*
>
> (For Anne Gregory — paraphrased)

I. What does the young man say about his hair? **1**

(A) Love for his hair is false
(B) It is admired but not loved for itself
(C) It is dyed
(D) It is the only thing he has

> **Ans: (B)** He thinks he is loved for it.

II. Who can love him for himself, according to the poem? **1**

(A) Nobody
(B) Only God
(C) His mother
(D) The lady

> **Ans: (B)** Only God.

III. The poem criticises the idea that love depends on _____. **1**

(A) wealth
(B) outward appearance
(C) honesty
(D) age

> **Ans: (B)** outward appearance.

IV. What message does the poem convey about real love? Answer in about 40 words. **2**

> Real love is for a person's inner self, not appearance (1); looks are superficial and cannot be the basis of true affection (1).

8. Answer any four of the following five questions in 40–50 words each. **(4 × 3 = 12)**

I. How did Anne Frank's relationship with Peter change over time? (From the Diary of Anne Frank)

> At first Anne finds him shy and awkward (1); she is hesitant but they gradually become close (1); she shares her thoughts with him (1).

II. Why did Valli's imagination make her ride the bus? What did the ride teach her? (Madam Rides the Bus)

> Valli longed to ride the bus (1); the journey brought both thrill and a sight of the dead cow (1); she learns that life is not only happy but also cruel (1).

III. How does Matilda's loss of the necklace affect her life? (The Necklace)

> The couple spend ten years in debt (1); she becomes old and rough with hard labour (1); the necklace was only an imitation (1).

IV. What changes take place in Bholi when she goes to school? (Bholi)

> She learns to read and gain confidence (1); the teacher's kindness helps her (1); she later stands against the greedy bridegroom (1).

V. Why did Lencho write a letter to God? (A Letter to God)

> Hail destroyed his crop (1); he believed God would help (1); he asked for a hundred pesos (1).

9. Answer any two of the following three questions in 40–50 words each. **(2 × 3 = 6)**

I. How does the thief trick Hari Singh in 'The Thief's Story'? (The Thief's Story)

> Hari wins Anil's trust (1); he pretends to be a servant (1); he steals the money, but is changed by Anil's kindness (1).

II. How does Mandela show that freedom must be for all? (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

> He speaks of the dignity of every race (1); he says courage is conquering fear (1); the oppressor and oppressed both need liberation (1).

III. How did Griffin's invisibility turn him into a danger to society? (Footprints Without Feet)

> Griffin used invisibility to escape suspicion (1); he stole money and became dangerous (1); the story shows science misused (1).

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) Discuss how 'The Ball Poem' and 'A Letter to God' present loss and how the characters respond to it. (The Ball Poem / A Letter to God)

> **Points:** boy loses ball; Lencho loses crop; the poet teaches responsibility; Lencho's faith; both learn about life; contrast of reaction — sorrow vs belief; maturity. (2+2+2)

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(B) Compare the ways in which 'Fire and Ice' and 'Amanda!' deal with strong feelings and the need for control. (Fire and Ice / Amanda!)

> **Points:** Frost's two end-of-the-world forces; Amanda's longing for freedom; both about control (desire/hate vs parental commands); tone; message. (2+2+2)

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 100–120 words. (1 × 6)

(A) 'Bholi' is a story of transformation. Discuss how education changes Bholi's life. (Bholi)

> **Points:** neglected child, slow speech; the teacher; school; confidence; refuses Bishamber; independence; value of education. (2+2+2)

O R

(B) Discuss how Nelson Mandela's address highlights the cost of freedom and the need for courage. (Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom)

> **Points:** inauguration day, history of apartheid; the sacrifice of heroes; courage vs fear; freedom of oppressor and oppressed; hope. (2+2+2)